

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Elizbar Keadze

Address: 23 Balmoral Way Sutton SM2 6PD

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer objects to the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I am writing to formally object to this planning application. I live on Balmoral Way, the cul-de-sac directly opposite the site entrance, and my road would be immediately affected by the extra traffic, parking pressure and activity this development would bring.

Paragraph 116 of the National Planning Policy Framework states that development should be refused on transport grounds where it would have an unacceptable impact on highway safety or where the cumulative impact on the road network would be severe. In my view, and based on the applicant's own evidence, that is clearly the case here.

The Transport Statement identifies Friday prayer "changeover" as the busiest period, with a worst-case overlap of up to 80 vehicles. Only 14 on-site parking spaces are proposed, 3 of which are expected to be used by staff, leaving just 11 for attendees. This means up to 69 vehicles would need to park on surrounding residential streets at peak times, with Balmoral Way likely to be most affected first. This is a significant and predictable shortfall. Our road is narrow, already heavily parked, and have limited turning space. They are not designed to cope with this level of demand. The likely result would be blocked driveways, cars parking on pavements, reduced visibility at junctions, unsafe reversing and turning, and vehicles repeatedly circling to find spaces.

The road layout makes matters worse. Dorset Road is the main access to the site and feeds into nearby residential streets, including Balmoral Way, which has no alternative exit. Even brief congestion or a single obstruction can disrupt the whole area because there is nowhere else for vehicles to go. With the identified parking deficit and clear peak surges in traffic, the overall impact on the local network would be severe in practical terms.

Safety concerns are heightened by the proximity of Avenue Primary Academy, which has over 1,000 pupils. The area already experiences heavy pedestrian movement at school drop-off and pick-up times, as well as after-school and weekend activities. The Dorset Road/Avenue Road junction is also on the S4 bus route, where passing can already be difficult. Adding concentrated vehicle arrivals and drop-offs linked to worship and community events would increase conflict between cars and children, reduce visibility, and raise the risk of accidents.

There are also concerns about emergency access. Extra on-street parking, informal drop-offs and possible double parking during busy periods would narrow the carriageway and could delay emergency vehicles or refuse collection. With limited access routes and no through roads, even temporary blockages could have wider safety consequences.

The proposal relies heavily on parking marshals and management measures instead of providing enough on-site parking. Such arrangements are difficult to guarantee or enforce over the long term and depend on constant supervision and voluntary compliance. They do not resolve the basic problem that the site does not have enough parking to meet its busiest demand. A development that only works if perfectly managed at all times cannot be considered properly mitigated.

The proposed hours, with community use from 07:00 to 22:00 and prayer potentially until 23:00, would also bring regular evening vehicle movements and noise into a quiet residential cul-de-sac. Repeated dispersal noise and traffic would affect the peaceful enjoyment of nearby homes, particularly for elderly and vulnerable residents.

In summary, this is a high-intensity use proposed in a constrained residential location with a clear and significant parking deficit acknowledged in the applicant's own documents. The resulting overspill and congestion would create unacceptable highway safety impacts and severe cumulative effects on the local road network. For these reasons, I respectfully request that Planning Application DM2025/01591 be refused.

It is also important to note that much of the support for this application appears to come from individuals who do not live close to the site and would not experience the day-to-day impacts of increased traffic, parking pressure and activity. While all views are valid, the concerns of residents who live immediately around the site and would be directly affected must carry greater weight, as we are the ones who would have to live with the consequences of this development on a daily basis.